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Lead Developer (Java)

HM Revenue and Customs

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 29th October 2026



HM Revenue
& Customs

Reference number

482176

Salary

£58,541 - £72,711

National minimum £58,541 - maximum £64,624

London minimum £65,869 - maximum £72,711

External applicants will join on the pay band minimum.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

HMRC - CDIO - CIO Borders & Trade - Core

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Bristol Regional Centre - 3 Glass Wharf

Cardiff Regional Centre - Ty William Morgan

Edinburgh Regional Centre - Queen Elizabeth House

Glasgow Regional Centre - Atlantic Square

Leeds Regional Centre - Wellington Place

Manchester Regional Centre - Three New Bailey
Telford - Plaza 1 and 2
Worthing - Teville Gate House
Stratford Regional Centre - Westfield Avenue

Please note that due to workforce controls, Stratford is only available to existing HMRC staff in these locations. HMRC staff based in Reading can also apply to move to Stratford in line with Migration path. HMRC staff based in 100PS can also apply to move to Stratford, however, please note that selecting London on your location preference choices refers to 100 Parliament Street and not the wider London area.

About the job

Job summary

Discover a career in your hands at HMRC. Whether you're seeking purpose, growth, or a workplace that gives you a true sense of belonging, hear from some of our employees as they share their story about what it's really like to work at HMRC.

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Visit our [YouTube channel](#) to watch the full series and come and discover your potential.

At HMRC we are committed to creating a great place to work for all our colleagues; an inclusive and respectful environment that reflects the diversity of the society we serve.

We want to maximise the potential of everyone who chooses to work for us and we offer a range of flexible working patterns and support to make a fulfilling career at HMRC accessible to you.

Diverse perspectives and experiences are critical to our success and we welcome applications from all people from all backgrounds with the experience and skills needed to perform this role.

At HMRC, we are already one of the most digital organisations in the UK. We have one of the largest data sources, and we're creating a world-class IT function. HMRC is building a modern, digital tax administration.

With 50 million customers to serve, over 60 thousand colleagues to support, and £600 billion to collect to fund UK Plc, our IT operation is huge. Operating at this level isn't for everyone, but those ready for the challenge will find unique opportunities to work with advanced technologies and create lasting impact.

Chief Digital and Information Office (CDIO) set the technology direction for HMRC and deliver the high-level design for all IT solutions.

We are responsible for building and running HMRC IT services along with providing IT change and operational support.

The Borders and Trade Delivery Group are responsible for the end to end service management and development of over 140 separate services, from the generation of Trade Statistics, to the administration of Customs and Excise duties.

This is an exciting role as a key member of the delivery team, collaborating with partners throughout the full delivery lifecycle to ensure delivery and support of highest-quality software products.

Our developers work closely with business analysts, testers and product owners within a truly collaborative environment.

Job description

As Lead Developer in HMRC, you will be responsible for setting technical direction, and ensuring the delivery of high-quality, scalable, and secure services.

You will guide and support a fast paced engineering team across the full service lifecycle, translating business and user needs into coherent technical designs, acting as an application architect, balancing strategic alignment with practical delivery, and remaining sufficiently hands-on to validate designs through prototypes or reference implementations.

You will lead low level solution design of complex large scale services and create corresponding documents and architectural diagrams. You must be proficient in a wide range of technical systems, and in identifying appropriate technology and approaches.

Alongside functional change, you would lead solution design to meet non-functional requirements such as resilience, performance, scalability and observability.

You will lead delivery of high quality software that meets user needs, and be responsible for overseeing the development of clean, secure code following a test-driven approach.

Key responsibilities

Set technical strategy and direction, ensuring architectural decisions, tooling choices and design approaches support scalable, secure, high-quality services.

Provide expert judgement and act as the escalation point for complex or high-risk technical issues, guiding teams towards robust solutions.

Act as a design authority for technical change to the service, ensuring all implementations align to HMRC Enterprise Architecture Patterns.

Oversee the full lifecycle of build/run/improve, ensuring services remain resilient, compliant and aligned to user and business needs, even when not personally hands-on.

Provide leadership to developers, delegating technical work, supporting planning, reviewing solution approaches, and ensuring development is on track and to the expected quality.

Assure security compliance, embedding secure-by-design principles and ensuring risks are understood and mitigated.

Lead on solution design & technical decision-making, including reviewing and challenging design choices (e.g., Redis persistence strategies, interface behaviours, microservice consolidation).

Ensures compliance with performance and design standards, influencing cross-team technology choices (e.g., SSO, Keycloak, REST template decisions).

Contribute to the development of robust, accurately estimated, project plans, considering risk and mitigation.

Critical decision making: Making and recording effective decisions following the appropriate decision-making criteria, framework or guidance.

Person specification

This role will suit an experienced technical leader who combines strong software engineering expertise with a specialism in application architecture and design. You will take ownership of technical direction, translate complex needs into coherent designs, and provide clear leadership throughout the service lifecycle.

Proactive and self-driven

Strategic and pragmatic

Design led

Strong technical judgement

Quality and resilience focused

Leads through influence

Governance and assurance minded

Hands on and credible

Collaborative communicator

Coaching & Continuous Improvement mindset

Outcome focused

Resilient under pressure

Additionally, the post holder will work normal office hours though may be required to occasionally attend the office outside of normal working hours (for example to support software releases). The post holder may be required to provide part of a 24/7 on-call Rota.

Essential Criteria

Demonstrable experience of producing detailed designs for complex, secure and resilient Java services, and acting as an application architect for enterprise-scale Java solutions

Strong Java engineering background, sufficient to challenge designs and validate implementation choices. Including the following accompanying technology:

REST APIs, Spring (Boot / Cloud / etc), REDIS, Kubernetes, Docker

Java Messaging (Kafka / RabbitMQ)

Relational and Non-Relational Database technologies (MySQL, Oracle, MongoDB)

Strong background in transforming high level solution designs into low level detailed implementation designs for enterprise scale, resilient, Java microservices (including design of; APIs, integrations, data flows, security controls, hosted on AWS technologies such as S3, EC2 and EKS)

Strong knowledge of enterprise scale microservice architecture and cloud native, distributed design patterns

Experienced in leading developers during advanced problem-solving during complex integration challenges

Experienced in a variety of UML diagram techniques including but not limited to sequence diagrams and data flow diagrams

Experience making and clearly communicating pragmatic technical decisions across multiple teams and stakeholders

Strong background in stakeholder management, proven collaboration with Business Analysis, Delivery Managers, Product Managers, and Business Representatives.

Desirable Criteria

Generative AI technology for use in Software Engineering

Awareness of Product Ways of Working

HMRC Borders and Trade domain knowledge

Further Location Information

Please ensure that you only apply for a location that you are willing and able to work from, as we will only make one offer of employment. Any additional notes included in a Further Location Preferences (optional) field within the application form, will not be considered. Please be aware that you cannot change your location preference after submitting your application.

Office Closures

If your location preference is for the following site, it's important to note that this is not long-term site for HMRC and we will require you to move to a new building in the future, subject to our location strategy and the applicable employee policies at that time.

For more information on where you might be working, [review this information on our locations \(opens in a new window\)](#)

This site is:

Telford Plaza, Telford - moving to Parkside Court, Telford

You will be given more information about what this means at the job offer stage.

Leeds Location

Moves Adjustment Payment will be available for this role, provided the successful applicant is a current HMRC colleague in Bradford and meets the eligibility requirements outlined in the HMRC's Moves Adjustment Payment guidance.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Leadership

Making Effective Decisions

Communicating and Influencing

Developing Self and Others

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,541, HM Revenue and Customs contributes £16,959 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit

Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

HMRC operates both Flexible and Hybrid Working policies, allowing you to balance your work and personal commitments. We welcome applications from those who need to work a more flexible arrangement and will agree to requests where possible, considering our operational and customer service needs.

We offer a generous leave allowance, starting at 25 days and increasing by a day for every year of qualifying service up to a maximum of 30 days.

Pension - We make contributions to our colleagues' Alpha pension equal to at least 28.97% of their salary.

Family friendly policies.

Personal support.

Coaching and development.

To find out more about HMRC [benefits](#) and find out what it's really like to work for HMRC [hear from our insiders](#) or visit [Thinking of joining the Civil Service](#)

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours and Experience.

How to Apply

As part of the application process, you will be asked to provide the following:

A name-blind CV focused on the roles and responsibilities most relevant to this position. Please provide concise evidence of experience at an appropriate level of seniority, including relevant hands on technical delivery if relevant. There is no need to include unrelated employment history. As a guide, this section should be no more than 1,000 words.

A 1000-word Personal Statement. Your Personal Statement should be used to describe how your skills and experience would be suitable for the advertised role, making reference to the Essential Criteria and Person Specification outlined in the advert.

Four separate 250-word statements addressing the specified Behaviours - Leadership (Lead Behaviour), Making Effective Decisions, Communicating and Influencing, Developing Self and Others.

Please evidence any Desirable Criteria where applicable (up to 250 words max). This is not essential for the role but may be considered by the vacancy holder where candidates have the same score at interview.

Further details around what this will entail are listed on the application form.

Prior to applications being sifted, candidates will be asked to complete an additional IKM assessment. Candidates will be sent details of the assessment once the advert has closed. This assessment is timed and is pass or fail; only those who pass will be considered at the sift stage. If you have any queries about the assessment, or require any reasonable adjustments, please contact talentacquisitionteam@hmrc.gov.uk Further details around what this will entail are listed on the application form.

Sift

In the event of a large number of applications being received, an initial sift may be held on the CV and lead behaviour Leadership.

At full sift all behaviour statements, your CV, and your Personal Statement, will be assessed, with the successful candidates being invited to interview.

We may also raise the score required at any stage of the process if we receive a high number of applications.

Interview

During the panel interview, you will be asked Experience based questions linked to the Essential Criteria. You will also be asked behaviour-based questions on Leadership, Making Effective Decisions, Communicating and Influencing, and Developing Self and Others to explore in detail what you are capable of.

Interviews will take place via video link. Sift and interview dates to be confirmed.

Please note that circumstances may arise that require the planned interview format to change. We will endeavour to provide you with as much notice of any change as possible.

Eligibility

Please take extra care to tick the correct boxes in the eligibility sections of your application form. Mistakes sometimes happen but if you contact us later than two working days (Monday-Friday) before the vacancy closes, we may not be able to reopen your application for you. If you do make a mistake with your eligibility form, or have withdrawn yourself in error and need your application reinstated whilst the campaign is still live, please contact us via: unitybusinessservicesrecruitmentresults@hmrc.gov.uk Use the subject line to insert appropriate wording for example Please re-open my application **[insert vacancy ref]** & vacancy closing date **[insert date]** .

To check that you are eligible to apply for this role, [please review the eligibility information before submitting your application](#).

Exceptionally, candidates who are not successful at this grade may be considered for appointment to similar roles at a lower grade where the eligibility criteria are met. If this applies, we will contact you directly.

Sponsorship

We have assessed this role against both Home Office and HMRC criteria and we are unable to offer sponsorship for a Skilled Worker Visa. This means the vacancy is not open to applicants who require visa sponsorship.

The HMRC app can help you with your application

The [HMRC app](#) can provide you with your past 5 years' employment history, making the process of filling in your application quicker and easier.

If successful in your application, you will need your National Insurance number for the onboarding process.

Download the [HMRC app](#) now and save your National Insurance number to your digital phone wallet.

How to download the HMRC app and sign up for an account

Download the free [HMRC app](#) from the App Store or Google Play store.

If you have an HMRC online account already, sign straight in using your ID and password. If not, you can prove your identity by answering some questions or providing your photo ID.

You will then be able to access the app quickly and easily by signing in using a 6-digit PIN, your fingerprint, or facial recognition.

You can find guidance for technical issues on GOV.UK: [Technical support with HMRC online services](#).

Reserve List

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months from which further appointments may be made for the same or similar roles – if this applies to you, we will let you know via your Civil Service Jobs account.

Merit List

After interview, a single merit list will be created, and you will only be considered for posts in locations you have expressed a preference for.

Appointments will be made in strict merit order in line with the set number of roles in each location.

Criminal Record Check

Applications received from candidates with a criminal record are considered fairly in accordance with the DBS Code of Practice and the Recruitment of ex-offenders Policy.

Hybrid working at HMRC

HMRC is an office-based organisation, and colleagues are expected to spend 60% of their working time in the office. Our offices provide opportunity for interaction, collaboration which aids learning and development and a sense of community. Where the role allows it, and where the home environment is suitable, colleagues can work from home for up to 2 days a week, averaged over a calendar month (or a proportionate amount of time for colleagues who work less than full time).

Reasonable Adjustments

We want to make sure no one is put at a disadvantage during our recruitment process. To assist you with this, we will reduce or remove any barriers where possible and provide additional support where appropriate.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact the UBS Recruitment team via unitybusinessservicesrecruitmentresults@hmrc.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Technical Support

If you are experiencing problems that cannot be resolved by our [help](#) section, then [technical support](#) is available. You will receive a reply in 2 working days.

Additional Security Information

Please note in addition to the standard pre-employment checks for appointment into the Civil Service, all candidates must also obtain National Security Vetting at Security Check (SC) clearance level for this vacancy. You will normally need to meet the minimum UK residency period as determined by the level of vetting being undertaken, which for SC is 5 years UK residency prior to your vetting application. If you have any questions about this residency requirement, please speak to the vacancy holder for this post.

From 1 April 2026, applicants will be required to meet updated nationality and residency requirements so that National Security Vetting (NSV) checks can be conducted. If this affects you, we will give you more information at the appropriate time.

Important information for existing HMRC contractual homeworkers

This role may be suitable for existing HMRC employees who are contractual homeworkers. Occasional attendance to the office will be required where there is a business need. Please consider the advertised office locations for this role when applying and only select locations from the [location preferences](#) section that you can travel to.

Terms and Conditions

Customer facing roles in HMRC require the ability to converse at ease with members of the public and provide advice in accurate spoken English and/or Welsh where required. Where this is an essential requirement, this will be tested as part of the selection process.

HMRC has a presence in every region of the UK. For more information on where you might be working, [review this information on our locations \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service values honesty and integrity and expects all candidates to abide by these principles. The evidence you provide in your application must relate to your own experiences.

Any instances of plagiarism or other forms of cheating will be investigated and, if proven, the relevant application(s) will be withdrawn from the process.

Recording of interviews is prohibited unless explicit agreement is sought in line with the UK General Data Protection Regulations.

Questions relating to an individual application must be emailed as detailed later in this advert.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5 year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

New entrants will join on the minimum of the pay band.

Please note that, if you are applying for roles on a part-time basis, the salary agreed will be pro-rata, reflective of the working hours agreed within your contract.

If you experience accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

For more Information for people applying for, or thinking of applying for, roles at HM Revenue and Customs, please see link: [Working for HMRC: information for applicants - GOV.UK](#).

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a standard (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	Gaynor Wood
Email :	gaynor.wood@hmrc.gov.uk
Telephone :	03000 593786

Recruitment team

Email : unitybusinessservicesrecruitmentresults@hmrc.gov.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. You have the right to complain if you feel there has been a breach of the Recruitment Principles.

In the first instance, you should raise the matter directly via ubsrecruitmentcomplaints@hmrc.gov.uk. Please note that we do not accept complaints or appeals regarding scoring of outcomes of campaigns unless candidates can provide clear evidence that the campaign did not follow the Recruitment Principles.

If you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their website.

